

Etsy SEO Cheat Sheet

How Etsy Search Works

Etsy ranks listings based on relevance (how well your listing matches what the buyer searched) and quality (how often people click and buy your listing). SEO improves relevance; great photos and prices improve quality.

The Most Important Fields

Title (140 characters): Put your most important keywords at the front. Write for search, not for reading. Example: "Handmade Ceramic Mug | Stoneware Coffee Cup | Pottery Gift | UK"

Tags (13 tags, 20 chars each): Use all 13. Repeat your most important phrases from your title. Think like a buyer — what would someone type to find this?

Categories: Choose the most specific category possible. This adds automatic tags you don't have to use yourself.

Keyword Research in 5 Minutes

1. Type your product into Etsy's search bar
2. Note the autocomplete suggestions — these are real buyer searches
3. Look at the top 5 listings for your product — what words do their titles use?
4. Check Etsy's "Related searches" at the bottom of results pages

Title Formula That Works

[Main product keyword] | [Material or method] | [Occasion or use] | [Style or colour] | [Location if relevant]

Example: "Woven Willow Basket | Handmade in Somerset | Storage Basket | Natural Rustic Home Decor | UK Maker"

Quick Wins

- Fill in all 13 tags — unused tags are wasted opportunities
- Use multi-word phrases, not single words ("handmade pottery mug" not just "mug")
- Update slow-selling listings with new keywords before giving up on them

- Free shipping (built into price) tends to improve conversion rate and ranking

What NOT to Do

- Don't keyword-stuff your description — it reads badly and Etsy doesn't use it for search
- Don't copy competitor titles exactly — Etsy can detect this
- Don't use irrelevant keywords — it hurts your conversion rate